STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-5020	
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 06/01/06	DATE REVISED **02/08/24**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL		RESOURCES		
SUBJECT ACTIVE SHOOTER		CROSS REFERENCE G-10410 FIELD COMMAND POST P-5000 HIGH RISK INCIDENTS		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the procedures for responding to an active shooter incident.

II. Policy:

It is the policy of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office to protect innocent life by any legal means possible. Deputies responding to an active shooter incident shall accomplish this goal by immediately using any legal means at their disposal to make contact with the active shooter and stop any further violence. This may include arrest, containment, or the use of deadly force.

The goal is to stop the active shooter before he or she can kill or seriously injure any more innocent people. This shall be the duty and responsibility of the initial responding deputies. The initial responding deputies are authorized to intervene prior to the arrival of command officers or specialty units.

These procedures are not intended to limit conventional law enforcement tactics, which may be appropriate to the situation, and are specific to an active shooter. These procedures represent a means of intervention available to deputies and with the use of these procedures there is the potential of elevated risk to the deputies. The risk is acceptable in light of the potential these procedures have for saving lives.

III. Definitions:

A. ACTIVE SHOOTER: An active shooter is a person (or persons) armed with a deadly weapon who has used deadly force to systematically or randomly inflict death or serious bodily injury and continues to do so while having unrestricted access to additional victims.

B. PATROL RESPONSE: The swift and immediate deployment of deputies and resources to an ongoing, life threatening situation where delayed deployment of personnel would likely result in death or serious bodily injury to innocent persons. Tactics are not a substitute for the conventional response to a high risk incident (see P-5000 High Risk Incidents).

IV. Procedures:

A. Activity Prioritization: Responding deputies shall attempt to perform activities in the following order of importance:

1. Stop the active shooter (by arrest, containment, or the use of deadly force).
2. Formulate a Rescue Task Force.
3. Evacuation.
4. Preserve the crime scene.

B. Contact Team-Deputy Responsibilities: All available deputies shall immediately respond to the scene of an active shooter. The initial responding deputies shall form a contact team if the situation allows (additional contact teams may be necessary if the incident is occurring in a large building). Circumstances may require entry and contact by as few as 1 or 2 deputies. The contact team shall immediately attempt to locate and stop the active shooter. The focus is to make contact as soon as possible to stop the active shooter by arrest, containment, or the use of deadly force.

1. The contact team shall consist of 1 or 4 deputies and shall use appropriate tactics while moving into and through the location.

2. Prior to the arrival of a supervisor, responding deputies shall be under the direction of a Sarpy County SWAT member, if available.

3. The contact deputies should attempt to enter the building from a location other than the main entrance, if possible, as this is the likely location for a barricade, explosive device, or an ambush.

4. The contact team leader shall notify Communications of the badge numbers of the deputies entering the location and the entrance point.

5. The contact team shall not do a thorough clearing of the building but shall move to the location the shooter is believed to be and attempt to make contact with the active shooter.

6. The contact team shall move past any injured parties. The contact team shall relay information regarding the location of injured parties to additional responding units.

7. If the contact team encounters a suspected explosive device, the location shall be reported to Communications and the device bypassed, if possible.

C. **Rescue Task Force-Deputy Responsibilities:** If a sufficient number of deputies have entered to establish contact with the suspect, additional responding deputies shall form a rescue task force with members of the fire department. The rescue task force shall be responsible for locating and removing injured victims and directing uninjured victims out of the building.

1. The rescue task force shall consist of 3 or 4 deputies and shall use appropriate tactics while moving into and through the location.

2. If a Sarpy County SWAT member is one of the initial responding deputies, he or she shall assume command of the rescue task force.

3. The rescue task force shall respond to locations it has been sent to by the Unified Command.

4. Deputies assigned to the rescue task force are responsible for team movement and the security of the team. They are not responsible for assessing injuries or physically moving injured parties.

5. The rescue task force members should remember that uninjured victims may be in shock and not respond to verbal commands.

6. The rescue task force should be prepared to encounter the active shooter or additional involved parties. The rescue task force should ensure all encountered parties are unarmed.

D. **Active Shooter-Supervisor/Command Officer Responsibilities:** The first supervisor or command officer, who is not assigned to a contact or rescue team, shall:

1. Establish a field command post and advise Communications of the location (see G-10410 Field Command Post).

2. Coordinate with the fire department to establish a unified command post.

3. Direct all additional units to respond to the designated staging area.

4. Determine the need for additional contact or rescue task force teams and assign personnel.

5. Begin high risk incident procedures (see P-5000).

6. Work towards evacuation and scene preservation.

E. **Training:** The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall provide initial training to all deputies in the procedures regarding responding to an active shooter incident to include active shooter response. The Sheriff's Office shall also provide periodic additional training in this area.